

Table 1: Quantifications of Two Variables

Statement	When True?	When False?
$\forall x \forall y P(x, y)$ $\forall y \forall x P(x, y)$	$P(x, y)$ is true for every pair (x, y)	There is a pair x, y for which $P(x, y)$ is False
$\forall x \exists y P(x, y)$	For every x there is a y for which $P(x, y)$ is True	There is an x such that $P(x, y)$ is False for every y
$\exists x \forall y P(x, y)$	There is an x for which $P(x, y)$ is true for every y	For every x there is a y for which $P(x, y)$ is False
$\exists x \exists y P(x, y)$ $\exists y \exists x P(x, y)$	There is a pair (x, y) for which $P(x, y)$ is True	$P(x, y)$ is False for every pair (x, y)

Example 5: Let $Q(x, y, z)$ be the statement " $x + y = z$ ". What are the truth values of the statements $\forall x \forall y \exists z Q(x, y, z)$ and $\exists z \forall x \forall y Q(x, y, z)$ where the domain of all variables consists of all real numbers?

Soln: Suppose that x and y are assigned values. Then, there exists a real number z such that $x + y = z$. Consequently, the quantification $\forall x \forall y \exists z Q(x, y, z)$ which is the statement "For all real numbers x and for all real numbers y there is a real number z such that $x + y = z$," is true.

The order of the quantification here is important, because the quantification $\exists z \forall x \forall y Q(x, y, z)$ which is the statement "There is a real number z such that for all real numbers x and for all real numbers y it is true that $x + y = z$," is false, because there is no value of z that satisfies the equation $x + y = z$ for all values of x and y .

1.5.4 Translating Mathematical Statements to Statements Involving Nested Quantifiers

Example 6: Translate the statement "The sum of two positive integers is always positive." into a logical expression.

Soln: $\forall x \forall y ((x > 0) \wedge (y > 0) \Rightarrow (x + y > 0))$ where the domain of both x and y are the set of integers.